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rescue boats, launching appliances and release gear ("the Requirements"), which has become mandatory under chapter III of the International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea (SOLAS), 1974 ("the Convention"), as amended by resolution MSC.404(96),

RECALLING FURTHER article VIII(b) and regulation III/3.25 of the Convention concerning the procedure for amending the Requirements,

TAKING INTO ACCOUNT the

MSC.535(107), with respect to ventilation means, and openings of the ventilation system and their means of closing for totally enclosed lifeboats,

RECOGNIZING the need to keep the Requirements up to date with regard to annual thorough examination and operational testing of ventilation systems,

HAVING CONSIDERED, at its 108th session,

and circulated in accordance with VIII(b)(i) of the Convention,

1 ADOPTS, in accordance with Article VIII(b)(iv) of the Convention,

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1 ADOPTS, in accordance with Article VIII(b)(iv) of the Convention,

Requirements for maintenance, thorough examination, operational testing, overhaul and repair

of lifeboats and rescue boats, launching appliances and release gear, the text of which is set

out in the annex to the present resolution;

2 DETERMINES, in accordance with article VIII(b)(vi)(2)(bb) of the Convention, that the amendments shall be deemed to have been accepted on 1 July 2025, unless, prior to that date, more than one third of the Contracting Governments to the Convention or Cont racting Governments the combined merchant fleets of which constitute not less than 50% of the gross tonnage of the world's merchant fleet have notified the Secretary -General of their objections

to the amendments;

3 INVITES SOLAS Contracting Governments to note that, in accordance with article VIII(b)(vii)(2) of the Convention, the amendments shall enter into force

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with article VIII(b)(vii)(2) of the Convention, the amendments shall enter into force on 1 January 2026 upon their acceptance in accordance with paragraph 2 above;

4 REQUESTS the Secretary -General, in conformity with Article VIII(b)(v) of the Convention, to transmit certified copies of the present resolution and the text of the amendments contained in the annex to all Contracting Governments to the Convention;

5 ALSO REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit copies of this resolution and its annex to Members of the Organization which are not Contracting Governments to the Convention.

RESOLUTION MSC.559(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024)

OPERATIONAL TESTING, OVERHAUL AND REPAIR OF LIFEBOATS AND RESCUE BOATS, LAUNCHING

APPLIANCES AND RELEASE GEAR (RESOLUTION MSC.402(96))

MSC 108/20/Add.1

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ANNEX

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ANNEX

EXAMINATION, OPERATIONAL TESTING, OVERHAUL AND REPAIR OF LIFEBOATS

AND RESCUE BOATS, LAUNCHING APPLIANCES AND RELEASE GEAR

(RESOLUTION MSC.402(96))

6 SPECIFIC PROCEDURES FOR INSPECTION, MAINTENANCE, THOROUGH

EXAMINATION, OPERATIONAL TESTING, OVERHAUL AND REPAIR

6.2 Annual thorough examination and operational test

1 Paragraph 6.2.3 is replaced by the following:

"6.2.3 For lifeboats (including free-fall lifeboats), rescue boats and fast rescue boats,

the following items shall be thoroughly examined and checked for satisfactory

condition and operation:

.1 condition of the boat structure including fixed and loose equipment

(including a visual examination of the external boundaries of the

void spaces, as far as practicable);

.2 engine and propulsion system;

.3 sprinkler system, where fitted;

.4 air supply system, where fitted;

.5 manoeuvring system;

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.2 engine and propulsion system;

.3 sprinkler system, where fitted;

.4 air supply system, where fitted;

.5 manoeuvring system;

.6 power supply system;

.7 bailing system;

.8 fender/skate arrangements;

.9 rescue boat righting system, where fitted; and

.10 v